

THREAT ASSESSMENT FOR THE PROTECTION OF SCHOOLS

A formal threat assessment team shall be established for each school for the assessment of and intervention with individuals whose behavior may pose a threat to the safety of school staff or students consistent with the model policies developed by the Virginia Center for School and Campus Safety (Virginia Department of Criminal Justice Services), including procedures for referrals to community services boards or health care providers for evaluation or treatment when appropriate. If the threat arises in the context of an emergency, all efforts will be first directed to neutralizing any imminent threat to life or property and protecting students and staff.

A. Team. Each school team shall include persons with expertise in counseling, instruction, school administration, law enforcement, including the School Security Officer and, in the case of any school in which a school resource officer is employed, at least one such school resource officer, and, where applicable and legally permitted, relevant members of outside agencies. Each team shall:

1. Provide guidance to students, faculty, and staff regarding recognition of threatening or aberrant behavior that may represent a threat to the community, school, or self;

2. Identify members of the school community to whom threatening behavior should be reported; and

3. Follow the threat assessment procedures specified in Regulation 8290 to assess and intervene with individuals whose behavior poses a threat to the safety of school staff or students. This requirement reflects the understanding that it is not only students who may pose a threat of harm to a school, but a range of others including (but not limited to):

- a. Students: current and former (and potentially prospective);
- b. Employees: current and former (and potentially prospective);
- c. Parents/guardians of students;
- d. Persons who are (or have been) in relationships with faculty, staff, or students;
- e. Contractors, vendors, or other visitors; and
- f. Unaffiliated persons.

4. New threat assessment team members shall complete an initial threat assessment training, and all threat assessment team members shall complete a refresher threat assessment training every three years.

B. Other Considerations for the Team. Based on the factors of the threat, team members may confer with relevant stakeholders, such as but not limited to, general education teacher of record, special education case manager, if applicable, and parents.

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C. Notification of Student Threats. Upon a determination that a student poses a threat of violence or physical harm to self or others, a threat assessment team shall immediately orally report its determination to the Superintendent or designee. For the purpose of this policy, the principal serves as the Superintendent's designee. The principal or designee shall immediately attempt to notify the student's parent or legal guardian. Nothing in this policy shall preclude School Division personnel from acting immediately to address an imminent threat. Similarly, notwithstanding, and subject to the provisions of this policy, LCPS's Safety & Security Office shall be informed of any relevant information about any student who school administrators and staff reasonably believe poses a security threat to the school or other individuals.

D. Criminal History. Upon a preliminary determination by the threat assessment team that an individual poses a threat of violence to self or others or exhibits significantly disruptive behavior or need for assistance, a threat assessment team may obtain criminal history record information, as provided in Virginia Code §§ [19.2-389](#) and [19.2-389.1](#), and health records, as provided in Virginia Code § [32.1-127.1:03](#). No member of a threat assessment team shall redisclose any criminal history record information or health information obtained pursuant to this policy or otherwise use any record of an individual beyond the purpose for which such disclosure was made to the threat assessment team.

E. Reporting. Each threat assessment team shall report quantitative data on its activities according to guidance developed by the Virginia Department of Criminal Justice Services.

F. Threats of Self-Harm. Threats of self-harm are not investigated through the threat assessment process but do require compliance with Virginia Code § [22.1-272.1](#) and LCPS Suicide Prevention and Risk Screening Guidelines.

[Former Policy: 8-31]

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Leg Refs: Code of Virginia, §§ [22.1-79.4](#); [19.2-389](#); [19.2-389.1](#); [32.1-127.1:03](#); [22.272.1](#).